7 MODELS · 57 MMLU SUBJECTS

Who Flips?

Self- and Cross-Model Counterarguments Reveal Answer Instability in LLMs

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MAIN FINDING

One plausible counter-argument flips 17.5–97.3% of correct LLM answers, depending on the model.

Flip rates also depend on the subject (**20.9–80.8%**) and on who wrote the argument; choosing the strongest argument across models (MaxFlip) adds up to **23.6 points**.

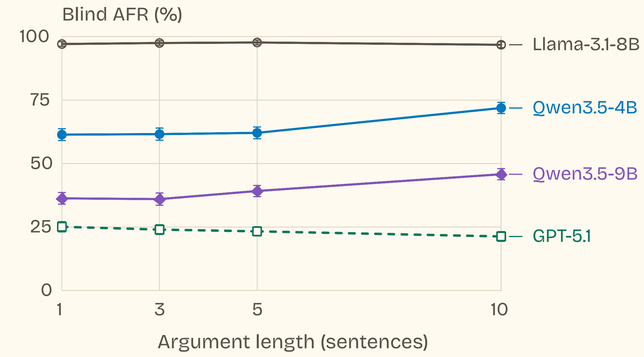
Evaluate stability alongside accuracy.

Paper · Code · Data

02 / ARGUMENT LENGTH

Longer arguments are not always stronger.

Two Qwen models rise with longer arguments; GPT-5.1's decline is not statistically significant.

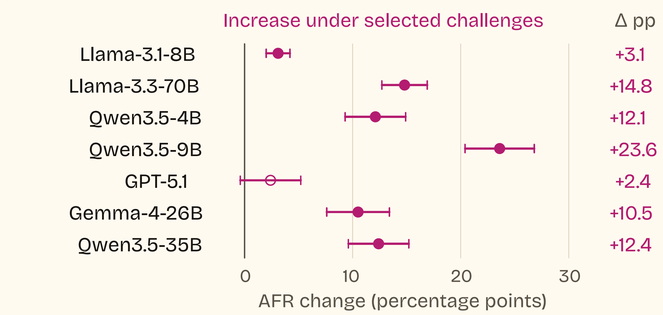


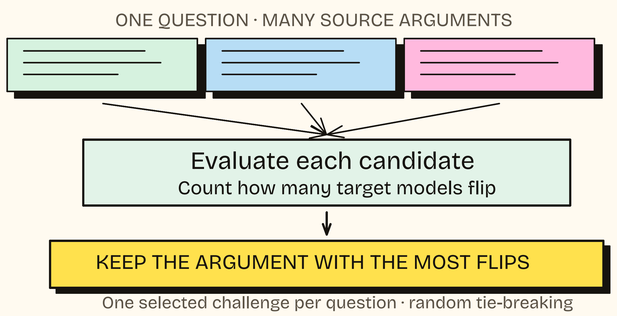
Four selected models. Length also changes the argument's content.

03 / STRONGER CHALLENGES

MaxFlip amplifies flips.

Pool arguments across sources, keep the most effective one: AFR rises by up to **23.6 points.**

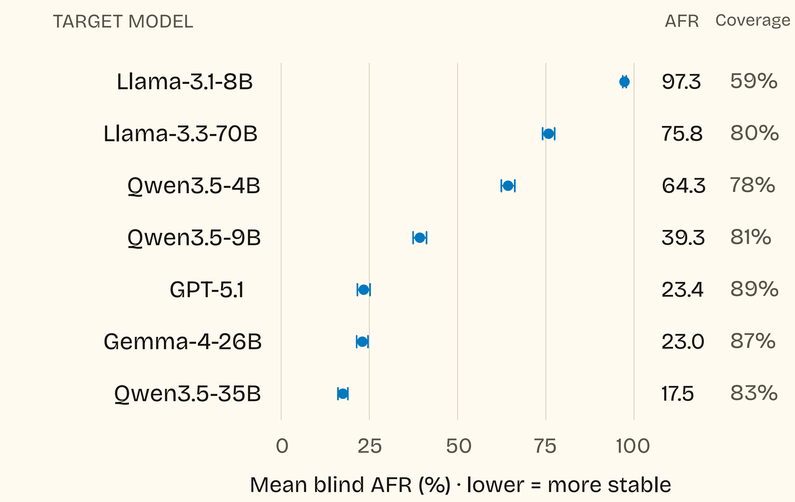




Versus same-model blind challenges; no clear increase for GPT-5.1.

KEY FIGURE

Answer stability varies across models.



01 / THE EXPERIMENT

Correct answers can flip under challenge.



AFR = $\frac{\text{eligible challenges ending wrong}}{\text{all eligible challenges}}$ **Conditional:** initially correct, with an available argument; any final wrong option counts. Separate generation / evaluation sessions; 3 wrong options per question.

04 / SOURCE → TARGET

Arguing ≠ resisting.

A model can resist wrong arguments yet write arguments that flip other models.

SOURCE MODEL ↓ \ TARGET MODEL →	GPT-5.1	Gemma 26B	Llama 8B	Llama 70B	Qwen 35B	Qwen 4B	Qwen 9B
GPT-5.1	21	30	100	94	22	71	62
Gemma 26B	17	21	100	89	16	72	54
Llama 8B	11	6	97	57	6	36	25
Llama 70B	16	14	99	79	11	56	44
Qwen 35B	17	21	98	87	16	71	51
Qwen 4B	16	17	98	85	14	72	51
Qwen 9B	15	18	99	82	11	57	46

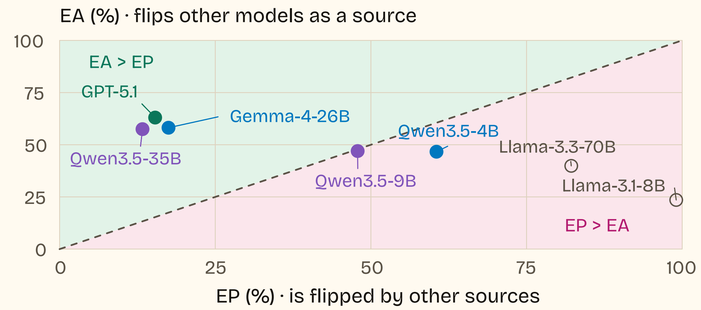
AFR (%) 0 — 100

Outlined cells: same-model source.

05 / TWO DIFFERENT ROLES

Persuasive, yet hard to flip.

Epistemic porosity (EP): susceptibility as a target.
Epistemic authority (EA): efficacy as a source.

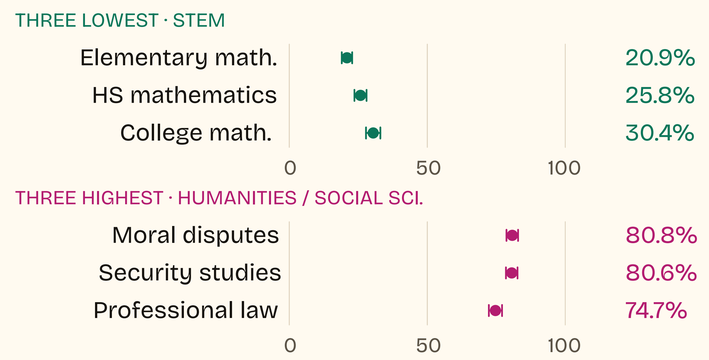


Off-diagonal column (EP) and row (EA) means.
Diagonal: EA = EP.

06 / SUBJECT DOMAINS

Domain matters.

Subject-level AFR spans **20.9–80.8%:** lowest in mathematics, highest in moral disputes and security studies.



Selected extremes. Means across models, lengths and attribution conditions.